

The next significant step in the development of wireless communication technologies came with the invention of the amplitude modulated (AM) radio. This allowed radio transmission by various stations at the same time, using different frequencies, as opposed to the then popular spark gap technology, which covered the whole allotted spectrum. This was achieved by Reginald Fessenden, who also managed to transmit violin music and Gospel readings over the air, to the delight of many ships at sea.

In 1909, the Nobel Prize in Physics was awarded to Guglielmo Marconi for his contributions to radio telegraphy technologies.

1909 also saw the development of radio broadcasting as we know it, with Charles David Harrolds, a professor of electronics from San Jose, setting up a radio station that continuously transmitted music and voice. Harrolds, the son of a farmer, set up the definitions for the terms broadcasting and narrowcasting (transmissions meant for a single recipient). Today, his station has grown into the KCBS San Jose station.

With the sinking of the Titanic in 1914, regulations were implemented that made it mandatory for all ships to have ship to shore radios manned 24 hours. This gave a huge boost to the then fledgling radio industry and propelled the world into a new era of radio telegraphy, and eventually radio telephony.

In 1916, the first radio station to broadcast daily was established by Harold Powers. With his company American Radio and Research Company (AMRAD) the station, call-signed 1XE, became the first to broadcast

The sinking of the Titanic was a blessing in disguise for the wireless industry

dance programs, university lectures, news, weather and even bedtime stories. The year 1920 witnessed the birth of the first broadcasting station for entertainment based in Argentina. Significant credit for the popularisation of audio radio must be given to the invention of the radio audio detector that saw the replacement of radio telegraphy.

In the 1920s, with the invention of the vacuum tube, the till then popular crystal set, based on spark gap technology, became obsolete. These radios, however, still have a huge fan